

Problem #5 (20 points). Here are some words and word combinations in Rotuman as well as their English translations:

<i>‘el‘ele</i>	shallow	<i>mamasa</i>	solid
<i>‘ele</i>	to be near	<i>matiti</i>	coldness
<i>‘olo</i>	to cut	<i>matit mamasa</i>	ice
<i>a‘öf fau</i>	year’s end	<i>moafmofa</i>	littered with rubbish
<i>fäeag ‘u‘u</i>	to use sign language	<i>niu</i>	copra
<i>fau</i>	year	<i>nu‘suar tiro</i>	window
<i>həfəfəfu</i>	rocky	<i>nu‘sura</i>	door
<i>huag ‘el‘ele</i>	impatient	<i>pala</i>	pierce
<i>huag to‘a</i>	courageous	<i>piri</i>	to curl
<i>hül həfu</i>	to blow (of a hurricane)	<i>poagpoga = palpala</i>	covered with holes
<i>hün kia</i>	base of the neck	<i>pogi</i>	night
<i>huli</i>	to turn over	<i>puhrəki</i>	to boil, to bubble up
<i>huni</i>	lower end	<i>pulu</i>	glue
<i>is ‘ā</i>	sharp-pointed	<i>kəlu</i>	bracelet; to encircle
<i>is susu</i>	nipple	<i>riamrima</i>	shiny
<i>lala</i>	deep	<i>rū huga</i>	stomach-ache
<i>maf tiro</i>	spectacles	<i>to‘a</i>	hero

- (a) Here are the Rotuman names of seven body parts as well as their English translations in arbitrary order. Determine the correct correspondences:

‘u‘u, isu, kia, leva, mafa, susu, huga
breast, eye, arm/hand, hair, heart, neck, nose

- (b) Translate into English:

tiro, poga (noun), *huag lala, həf puhrəki, maf pogi = maf pala*.

- (c) Translate into Rotuman:

round; to cut copra; curly hair; sticky; to flash; rubbish.

- (d) Using the material given above you cannot translate ‘word’ and ‘to exhaust’ into Rotuman with certainty. What would the theoretically possible translations of these words into Rotuman be?

⚠ Rotuman belongs to the Austronesian family. It is spoken by approx. 9000 people in Fiji. ‘ is a consonant (the so-called glottal stop); *a* is an open *o*; *ā* $\approx$ *a* in *crack*; *ō* = French *eu* or German *ö*; *ū* = French *u* or German *ü*. The mark “ $\bar{}$ ” denotes vowel length.

Copra is the dried kernel of a coconut.

—Boris Iomdin, Alexander Piperski

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Good luck!